

Newsletter Number 54



FUTURE MEETINGS

Monday 22 June at Old Priory, behind the Old Vicarage, at 7.30pm

Brian Graves, Producer of G&S Productions

“ Rejuvenation and Regeneration”

The presentation will cover the following topics:

1. Beauty and the Beast: The first celebrity pantomime in Great Yarmouth in over 30 years.
2. No Child Left Behind: Our community sponsorship program designed to provide underprivileged children with the opportunity to experience the Christmas pantomime.
3. Gates Academy of Music and Performing Arts: Our vision to "Rejuvenate and Regenerate" by creating a professional performing arts and music school in Great Yarmouth, repurposed from local buildings, at a standard comparable to the BRIT School and LIPA.
4. Economic and Social Impact: What these initiatives mean for the town's growth across education, property, leisure, and the hospitality industry.

Saturday 20 June. National Civic Day

Meeting in Market Place at 10am to clean all the Street Furniture.

This will involve cleaning the litter bins, sign posts, bollards etc. If you are willing to help please bring bucket, brushes, cloths and water.

Friday 10 July in Gorleston Library

Simon Smith, Managing Director of Dunk Ink Ltd

“Presentation of latest Masterplan of the North Quay Development”

August (Date to be confirmed). Visit to Beccles following last year's heritage trail followed by visit to Beccles Museum ending with tea at The Waveney Hotel.

RECENT MEETINGS

Thursday 16 April in the Beehive, at The Place (The old Palmers) at 2.30pm

Gavin Hetherington, Retired Engineer.

"Non Designated Heritage Assets in Great Yarmouth."

Gavin has an interest in heritage and history and has been concentrating on interesting buildings and places in the area around his home i.e. north of St George's Park as part of a study by the Society to record this data in the 8 conservation areas in the Town. There are over 800 listed buildings in the Borough and 217 of them are in the town.

Grounds for inclusion of interesting buildings and places depends on asset type, age, rarity, architectural and aesthetic value, group value and architectural interest. He illustrated this with some examples.

St. George's Park which was laid out in 1866 and contains the two war memorials which are listed. Since then several interesting features have been added to the entrances to the Park.

43 York Road used to be a Baptist Church which was built in 1841 and ended its life as a chapel in 1965. It was then taken over as a Pentecostal Church in 1973 and is now a house. It has some elements of Gothic Revival architecture.

The Artillery Drill Hall was built in 1880 and a two storey extension was added in 1906. Its military life ended in 1950 and it then became a furniture store. It is now up for sale.

The Columbia Tavern at the bottom of Crown Road was built in 1859 and was bought by Lacons in the 1930s. It has a fascinating totem pole which is topped by the Lacon's falcon.

37 Albion Road is where St. Mary's School had originally been and previously there had been a windmill here. The striking features are the very impressive brick walls and gate.

He also spoke about the Empire Theatre, Arcade designed by Cockrill which is now Leisure Land, 72 and 72a Albion Road which is a three storey building erected in Victorian times and a Pillar Postbox designed by John Penfold (1828-1909) which is now near St. George's Theatre Plaza.

Thursday 21 May in South Quay Gallery and Learning Centre at 6.30pm

Art Exhibition by Darren Barker, CEO of Great Yarmouth Preservation Trust

This was an opportunity to view the recently opened South Quay Gallery and Learning Centre run by Pete and Moria Huggins and to see a selection of paintings by Darren Barker.

Pete is an internationally known photographer and Moira had produced some very tasty snacks along with various drinks. It was an opportunity to view the art galleries on the first two floors, the cafe and the courtyard. The Gallery is open Wednesday to Sunday from 10am to 6pm and there is an opportunity to participate in various art classes. Darren was available to discuss his works all of which are on sale until 21 June.

GREENING UP

We have been providing planters and planting them up with various plants. We have been working on the St. Nicholas Preparatory School Gardens and encouraging and helping residents in the eastern end of Crown Road to spruce up their front gardens.

NELSON COLUMN

The area around the Nelson column is in a poor state and in the next few weeks we are planning to kill off the weeds and clean up the benches and Display boards.

FUTURE ACTIVITIES

The Competition for Shops, businesses and market stalls is planned for the autumn and we are hoping to have another competition for Young Community Champions. We have been working with council officers about improvements to the Town Wall and an official opening should happen in June.

Best wishes, Hugh Sturzaker

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